

POPCORN IN THE TIDYING LABYRINTH

Popcorn in the Tidying Labyrinth

Toy cars, modeling clay, scattered socks, books everywhere...
The chaos that fuels creativity can also consume –
and trap you in a labyrinth.

Things go missing, monsters appear –
and even the superhero loses his cape!

In this story, we follow Pipoca as he discovers
that tidying up isn't punishment,
but a way to prepare for even greater flights.

Because growing up also means learning to organize the world –
inside and out –
without ever giving up on dreaming and flying.
But not too high... so you don't get burned.



Popcorn in the Tidying Labyrinth

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Illustrations created with the help of Sora and ChatGPT.

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To my daughter,
who, with her creative little messes,
spread joy and love throughout the house.
Caring is being responsible for all the little things we love.



Popcorn, like every child, lives between chaos and care,
between fertile imagination and the boundaries of drawers.

Reading this story with a child means diving headfirst into that universe where,
between missing things, surprises, and mess,
we discover the value of care –
and the beauty of order that arises without losing the magic of imagination.

May this book be a chance to create memories,
to laugh, talk, and fly together with joy and affection,
finding, page by page, the delicate balance between order and disorder.



Pipoca loved to play.
He drove his little red car right through the mess.
The floor was covered in blocks, pencils, papers, books,
toys everywhere.
And he didn't mind – playing was what mattered most!



But that night...
Something happened... His favorite car disappeared!



[illegible]

The next day, Pipoca took off his shoes and socks and tossed them on the floor. He left everything there, just like that, without hesitation.
— Now I have to go draw! — he thought, excited.

A cartoon illustration of a yellow dinosaur with blue spots and a blue collar, sitting on a wooden chair. The dinosaur is putting on a blue and white striped sock on its right foot. A blue sneaker is on the floor next to it. The room is messy, with various toys, shoes, and socks scattered on the floor. In the background, there is a hanging basket and a bookshelf. The scene is lit with warm, orange light.

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But by the end of the day...
Something happened... His favorite sock disappeared!



Popcorn also loved playing with modeling clay.
He made two funny-eyed creatures – and forgot to put
them away.



The following day...
Something happened... the clay creatures had turned
into stone monsters!



After coming back from school, Popcorn wanted to play
with his Superman toy.
But... where's the red cape?



Without the cape, Superman couldn't fly.
And Popcorn cried.



That's when Popcorn remembered Mom's advice.
He took a deep breath... and started tidying up.



He organized the books, lined up his toy cars,
put away blocks, pencils, and papers – each in its
drawer.



He tidied his clothes: socks and underwear in one drawer, t-shirts and shorts in another. He even sorted them by color!

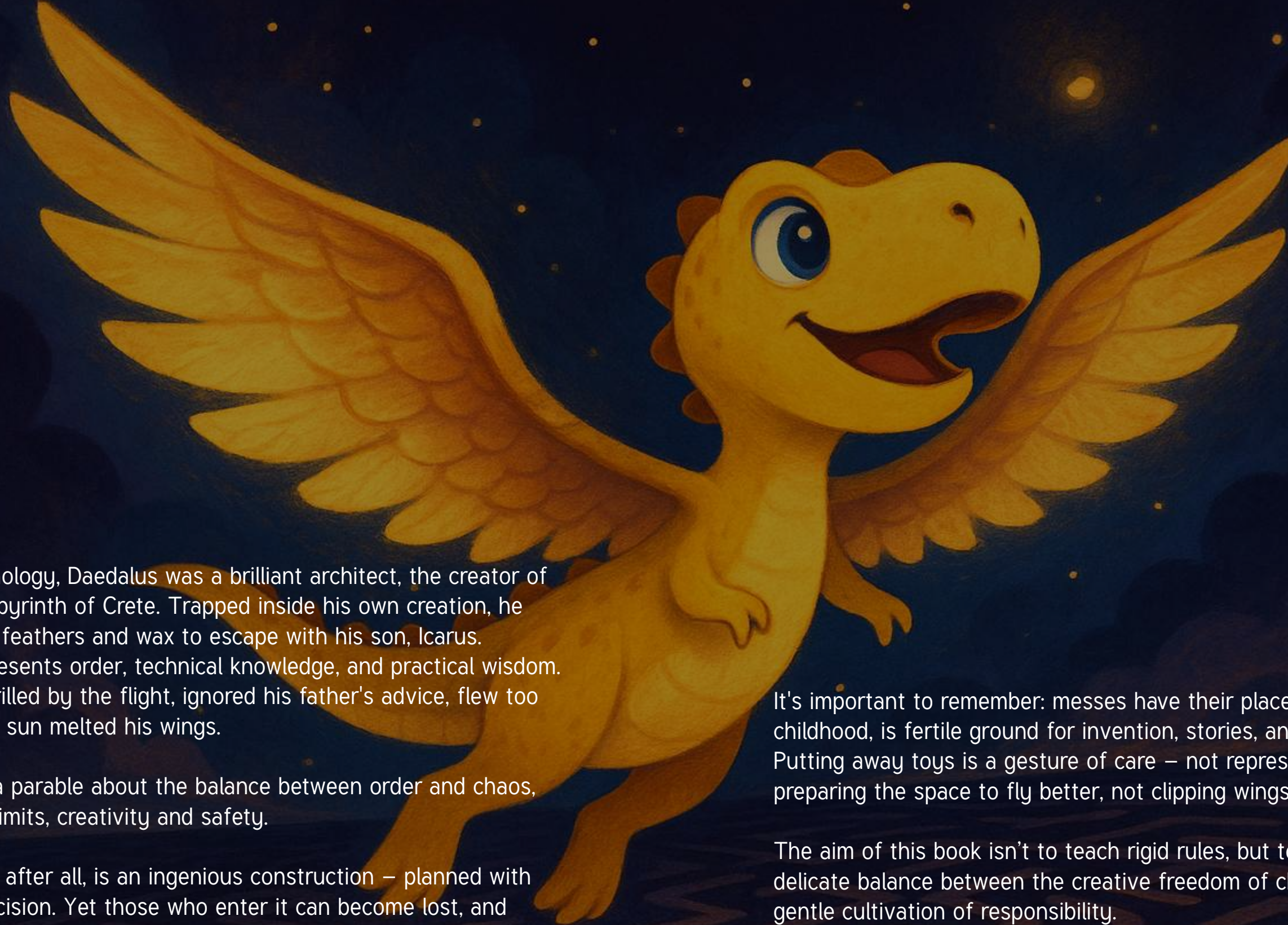


When he was done...
there it was: the red cape.
Superman could finally fly!



Now Popcorn played happily.
But he gave an important warning:
– Don't fly too high! Or the cape might catch fire!





In Greek mythology, Daedalus was a brilliant architect, the creator of the famous labyrinth of Crete. Trapped inside his own creation, he built wings of feathers and wax to escape with his son, Icarus. Daedalus represents order, technical knowledge, and practical wisdom. But Icarus, thrilled by the flight, ignored his father's advice, flew too high... and the sun melted his wings.

This story is a parable about the balance between order and chaos, freedom and limits, creativity and safety.

The labyrinth, after all, is an ingenious construction – planned with order and precision. Yet those who enter it can become lost, and things disappear. In the same way, a child's room may seem chaotic, but it's full of meaning for the one who lives there. And even tidying up, if too rigid, can become a maze of rules where creativity hides or gets lost.

It's important to remember: messes have their place too. Chaos, in childhood, is fertile ground for invention, stories, and discovery. Putting away toys is a gesture of care – not repression. Organizing is preparing the space to fly better, not clipping wings (or capes).

The aim of this book isn't to teach rigid rules, but to celebrate the delicate balance between the creative freedom of childhood and the gentle cultivation of responsibility.

Because growing up is, after all, learning how to fly... without forgetting not to go too high.